

File No. 15 (17) - W (Secret)

Collection A

1941.

Destroy in 1953

Government of India,
External Affairs Department,
War Branch.

Pres. Nos. (1) - (3)
Serial

9

Subject.

Kenships Interception -
Smuggling of tea from India.

Previous References.

Later References.

NAIDLF00919203

Secret.

D.422-I.B./41.

C.No.193-CusI/41.

D.1425-W/41.

File No 7/3-7/4
Record (10 yrs)
8/1/42

(2)
Intelligence Bureau, Home Department.

The attached copy of a letter from Khimji Ramda Cutch-Mandvi, to Messrs. Khimji Ramdas, Muscat, together with marginally noted remarks of the G.S. Branch is forwarded for information and retention.

Sd/- M.K. Johnston,

Commerce Department

Political Department

D.I.B.U.O.No.2/AG./41-(1), dated 11-Feb 1941.

The Department of Commerce, C.B.R. and the E.A. Deptt. may see after the issue of the draft to the Resident for the States of W.I.

Ild.ZHB.4.2.41.
Sd. S.S. 6.2.41.

Sd/- C.P.Hancock, 6.2.41.

Sd/- C.G.Herbert, 7.2.41.

S (2). Issue Pol. Deptt

Seen in Com. Dept. A copy of these papers has also been received in this Department.

Ild.K.S.III

Sd/- Illegible.
13.2.41.

C.B.R. U.O. 14.2.
C.D.u.o.149-Tr./41, d/-15.2.41.

Seen in the C.B.R.
Sd. A.S. 20.2.41.

Sd/- K.G. Jacob, 21.2.41.

E.A. Deptt.

C.B.R.u.o.C.No.193-CusI/41, d/-22.2.41.

A copy of the correspondence at pages 1-2 may be sent to the A.G.G. Baluchistan and the Political Agent Muscat. Draft put up.

Sd. S.K. 1.3.41.

Ild.
S.R.N.1.3.41.

Sd/- R.K.M. Saker, 3.3.41.

S (2). Issue

D.I.B. (by name) Mr

E.A. D.U.O No. D.1425-W/41, d 7/3/1941

SECRET.

(1) Copying for B.
No. 110/MIK/Let/1.
MISCO., Karachi.
18.12.40

Letter intercepted in the Post.

From :- KHIMJI RAMDAS,
Cutch-Mandvi.
To:- Messrs. KHIMJI RAMDAS,
Muscat. Arabia.

Gujrati Letter Dt. 8.12.40.

Subject:- TEA & CORN.

Translation:-

Re: Tea we have enclosed herewith a letter addressed to the Political Agent. Please put this in a separate cover and deliver the letter personally and explain to him that there was a similar order in Cutch and the permission was granted for goods already imported and no more of it was to be reshipped henceforth. Like should be done here. To explain to you more clearly I have enclosed herewith a letter of DWARKABHAI. Please keep this letter private and

do all the things accordingly. Please keep the English letter in absolute privacy and do everything yourself writing "Personal" on the cover

.....
Translation of the enclosed letter.

20 Abdul Gaffar Road,
Warli, Bombay.
5.12.40.

Dear Mr. GOKALDAS,

Pasni is 750 miles away from Mustang. You can go to Khatlat via Mustang. Harbour of Pasni is with Khatlat State authority, with a Nawab at the head. He had no idea that tea could be exported from his state (only with the permission of Tea Export License Committee), so upto now intregues went on. But now the licensing committee was wise to the fact that so much quantity of tea was imported by this state and chereby the Indian dealers were exporting tea to other neutral ports, and they have approached the state authority through the Political Department. Now the Nawab has put a ban to this. In my opinion we will not get any permission. Our case is to be put up like this:- The Nawab puts a small import duty on tea but on the same tea he takes export duty as well. Both these duties have been paid on the quantity of tea which is lying at Pasni. There was no such rule that tea cannot be exported. So he can only put a ban on any new quantity of tea being re-exported from his state. Our consignment cannot be stopped because there was no such rule at the time when we imported. Something has happened at Cutch Mandvi. When the licensing Committee was satisfied that so much quantity of goods is exported from Cutch Mandvi they came to some terms with the state authority that such things should not happen again. The dealers had their consignments of tea lying at Cutch Mandvi and they had the permission to ship the goods on condition that they will not ship any tea coming in to Cutch Mandvi after this. We have applied in the similar manner. You will know more about this from Mowjee's son KUNJI who is there. In my opinion you please write to the British Consul there about this as he may not be quite aware about these facts and so he may write to the Political Agent, there. In your case British Consul shall write to the Political Agent that he knows the dealer to whom these 54 cases of tea belong and he is our subject and these 54 cases have come to Pasni after incurring so much expenses and these goods are for local consumption, and so they should give you a permit. If such a letter comes from the Consul you will be released from all these troubles. Nothing is known that the Consul will or is willing to help you in this.

Sd/- Dwarka Bhai.

....

Another /...

4

Another letter enclosed in English.

To

Major HECKINBOTHAN, OBE.,
Muscat.

Dear Sir,

I arrived here on the ulti. My brother MATHRADAS already married on the 17th ult. with great pleasure.

I am taking an opportunity to write you a letter and also give you some trouble.

I have shipped 54 cases of tea from Calcutta to Pasni (a sea port belonging to Khalat State) to be reshipped to and sold in Muscat. This was my first shipment of this kind. I did this and others were doing the same. But as soon as my shipment arrived in Pasni at a very great expense and after duties etc. paid on same to Kalat State. The State prohibited reshipment of same from Pasni, on enquiry I am to know that they are now asking for tea export licensing Committee Certificate for same now this certificate costs almost as much as the whole value of tea itself. My point is this that the state can prevent these exports from their state for further shipment, and the merchants will bring the tea duly considering this extra expense. But they should allow the shipment to be made for the cargo that arrived before such notification. Particularly so as the state has taken duty on such imports in their state. Of course they may ask for an assurance that this cargo should not go to any enemy port in which case I am sure you can assure them on my behalf if need be.

I humbly beg to request your honour that if you yourself or through P. R. or any one else wherever your influence goes and if possible can arrange as a special case special for me to release ~~for~~ for only this time to export the same 54 cases of tea from the said port to Muscat otherwise I am to suffer in great loss in this trade.

I am here quite alright hoping you the same. I shall be glad to execute your order if any.

I am yours obediently,
Gokaldas Khemji.

Secret

EA DEPARTMENT.

War BRANCH.

Draft Letter
Memorandum
Telegram

File No.

Serial No.

Class for telegrams

Ordinary
Express
Urgent*
Priority
Clear Line†

*Only for
Foreign
Telegrams
†Not for
Foreign
Telegrams.

No.

Dated

19 .

D. 422-IB/41

March 18.2.1941

To

The Hon'ble the Resident for the
States of Western India.

.....

Subject:- Smuggling of tea from India.

...

Sir,

I am directed to forward, for
information, a copy of the papers
noted in the margin.

I have etc.,
sd/C. G. Herbert. rbr

A. P. S.

(Code word for telegrams.)

* Letter from Khimji Ramdas, Cutch-
Mandvi to Messrs. Khimji Ramdas,
Muscat dated 8.12.1940, with
enclos.

2. Letter from Gokaldas Khemji
to Major Hickinbotham,
OBE., Muscat.

S. 5.

MGHFC-S'-2443 (S&P) MFP-(M-2148)-8-12-37-\$0,000 Pa 37

EA DEPARTMENT.
War BRANCH.

Secret File No.
Serial No.

Draft Letter
Memorandum
Telegram

Class for telegrams

Ordinary
Express
Urgent*
Priority
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*Only for
Foreign
Telegrams
†Not for
Foreign
Telegrams

No. Dated 19 :
D. 1425-W/41.6 March 1941

To be issued on

Issued on

1st Reminder

2nd Reminder

3rd Reminder

Heading :

Case or Diary No.

If post copy of telegram required

Date of despatch of above

List of enclosures

(Code word for telegrams.)

* Letter from Khimji Ramdas, Cutch
Mandvi, to Messrs. Khimji Ramdas,
Muscat, dated the 18.12.1940 (with
enclos).

To

1. The Hon'ble the A.G.G.R and C.C.
in Baluchistan.
2. The Political Agent, Muscat.

Subject:- Smuggling of tea from
from India.

Sir,

I am directed to forward
for information a copy of the
*
letter noted in the margin.

I have etc.,

U.S.

S. S.

MOIPC-S-2443 (S&P) MFP-(M-2146)-8-12-37-80,000 Pads.